AURELIUS DIGITAL SYSTEMS PVT. LTD.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

HR-HBK-01 | Version 6.2

Field	Controlled value
Document ID	HR-HBK-01
Version	6.2
Effective date	2026-07-01
Review date	2027-06-30
Classification	INTERNAL
Owner	Kavita Menon (CHRO)
Approver	Ananya Rao (CEO)
Department	People & Culture
Applicability	All employees; selected provisions explicitly extended to non-employee workers
Status	APPROVED - CONTROLLED INTERNAL DOCUMENT

Fictional enterprise notice: Aurelius Digital Systems Pvt. Ltd., its identities, systems and internal rules in this document are fictional.

Document Control

HR-HBK-01-DC01 - Document-Control Record

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Controlled repository	VaultPoint DMS
Distribution	Authorized workforce and functions according to classification and applicability
External-law treatment	Where a decision depends on external law or a client obligation not contained here, obtain verified guidance from Legal & Corporate Affairs.

Revision History

HR-HBK-01-RH01 - Revision History

Version	Effective / status	Meaningful change
4.2	Prior controlled release	Initial controlled issue and consolidation of predecessor guidance.
4.7	Prior controlled release	Expanded scope, roles and source-of-truth controls.
5.2	Prior controlled release	Aligned enterprise systems, approval vocabulary and document interfaces.
5.6	Prior controlled release	Added clearer exception, recordkeeping and manager/accountability rules.
5.9	Prior controlled release	Refreshed operational workflows, conditional rules and cross-document handoffs.
6.2	2026-07-01	Current release aligned to enterprise governance baseline and approved process design.

Precedence: This document controls only within its approved subject. Specialist policies, standards and procedures control detailed requirements in their own subject matter; unresolved conflicts are escalated to the relevant Policy Owners.

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Document Governance and Use

Provide the employee-facing orientation and authoritative summary layer for employment life at Aurelius, while routing detailed entitlements, controls, procedures, and exceptions to specialist documents.

Company overview; employment categories; probation; working arrangements; compensation/benefits overview; leave overview; workplace standards; responsibilities; learning; mobility; grievances; discipline; separation; retirement; references. Detailed specialist controls remain outside handbook ownership.

Audience: All employees; managers; People & Culture; selected provisions for non-employee workers where expressly extended.

Controlled-source rule: Convenience copies, email extracts, screenshots and local notes do not supersede the controlled document or authoritative enterprise system for the relevant fact.

HR-HBK-01-DG01 - Document Dependencies

Dependency type	Documents
Primary	
Control	

1 Handbook Purpose, Status and How to Use It

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 1 Handbook Purpose, Status and How to Use It | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Handbook Purpose, Status and How to Use It establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

1.1 Purpose and intended use

Purpose and intended use is governed as part of Handbook Purpose, Status and How to Use It. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For purpose, intended, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

HR-HBK-01-T01 - Handbook Source-of-Truth Routing Matrix

Control point	Required treatment	Evidence
Business purpose	Must be defined before action or approval	Request/workflow record
Independent approval	No self-approval where requester benefits or is conflicted	Approval history
Specialist trigger	Route Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance/HR review when criteria apply	Concurrence record
Exception	Document scope, justification, controls and expiry	Approved exception record

1.2 Relationship to specialist policies

Relationship to specialist policies is governed as part of Handbook Purpose, Status and How to Use It. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For relationship, specialist, policies, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

1.3 Applicability and local/client variations

Applicability and local/client variations is governed as part of Handbook Purpose, Status and How to Use It. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For applicability, local, client, variations, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

1.4 How to identify authoritative sources

How to identify authoritative sources is governed as part of Handbook Purpose, Status and How to Use It. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For identify, authoritative, sources, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

2 About Aurelius Digital Systems

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 2 About Aurelius Digital Systems | People & Culture | INTERNAL

About Aurelius Digital Systems establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

2.1 Company profile and operating model

Company profile and operating model is governed as part of About Aurelius Digital Systems. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For company, profile, operating, model, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

2.2 Functions and office locations

Functions and office locations is governed as part of About Aurelius Digital Systems. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For functions, office, locations, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

2.3 Hybrid and client-site operating context

Hybrid and client-site operating context is governed as part of About Aurelius Digital Systems. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For hybrid, client, operating, context, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Operational scenario S01: New Band 1 employee asks whether handbook leave wording or PeopleHub balance controls entitlement. Apply the requirements in Employee Handbook to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

2.4 Employee responsibilities in a controlled enterprise

Employee responsibilities in a controlled enterprise is governed as part of About Aurelius Digital Systems. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For employee, responsibilities, controlled, enterprise, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

3 Employment Framework

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 3 Employment Framework | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Employment Framework establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

3.1 Employment categories

Employment categories is governed as part of Employment Framework. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For employment, categories, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

HR-HBK-01-T02 - Employment Category Quick Reference

Category	Status	Banded	Core treatment
RFT	Regular Full-Time Employee	Yes	Indefinite-duration full-time employment under company terms.
RPT	Regular Part-Time Employee	Yes	Indefinite-duration part-time employment; benefits and attendance may be prorated by specialist policy.
FXT	Fixed-Term Employee	Yes	Employment for a stated term or project period; terms may differ where specialist policy states.
INT	Intern	No	Time-limited learning/work assignment; access and benefits are role-specific.
APP	Apprentice	No	Structured learning/work programme; specialist terms govern.
CTR	Individual Contractor	No	Individual providing contracted services directly or through an approved contracting arrangement.
CNS	Consultant	No	Specialist advisory or delivery resource engaged under a services arrangement.
TMP	Temporary Staff	No	Short-duration staffing resource supplied or engaged for operational need.
VND	Vendor Personnel	No	Personnel of an approved supplier with logical, physical, or service access to Aurelius resources.

3.2 Employee bands and title conventions

Employee bands and title conventions is governed as part of Employment Framework. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For employee, bands, title, conventions, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

3.3 Employment records and PeopleHub

Employment records and PeopleHub is governed as part of Employment Framework. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For employment, records, peoplehub, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

HR-HBK-01-T03 - Band 1–8 Orientation Table

Band	Label	Typical titles	Leadership expectation
Band 1	Associate	Graduate Engineer, Associate Analyst, Support Associate, Junior Consultant	Individual contributor; supervised delivery
Band 2	Professional	Engineer I, Analyst, Consultant, Specialist	Independent contributor within defined scope
Band 3	Senior Professional	Senior Engineer, Senior Analyst, Senior Consultant, Senior Specialist	Advanced contributor; may mentor or lead work packages
Band 4	Lead / Manager	Lead Engineer, Lead Analyst, Manager, Delivery Lead	Team/workstream leadership or senior individual contribution; may hold people or budget responsibility
Band 5	Principal / Senior Manager	Principal Engineer, Senior Manager, Principal Consultant, Product Manager	Multi-team or major-domain accountability
Band 6	Director	Director, Engineering Director, Practice Director, Senior Principal	Department/practice leadership; significant budget, people, or technical authority
Band 7	Vice President	Vice President, Senior Vice President, Executive Vice President	Major function/sub-function leadership and delegated executive authority
Band 8	Executive Leadership	Chief Executive, Chief Officer, General Counsel	Enterprise executive accountability

3.4 Changes to employment status

Changes to employment status is governed as part of Employment Framework. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For changes, employment, status, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

3 Employment Framework - continued

4 Probation, Confirmation and Early Employment

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 4 Probation, Confirmation and Early Employment | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Probation, Confirmation and Early Employment establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

4.1 Probation overview

Probation overview is governed as part of Probation, Confirmation and Early Employment. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For probation, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Operational scenario S02: Fixed-term employee asks whether a benefit described for regular employees automatically applies. Apply the requirements in Employee Handbook to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

4.2 Manager and employee expectations

Manager and employee expectations is governed as part of Probation, Confirmation and Early Employment. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For manager, employee, expectations, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

4.3 Confirmation outcomes

Confirmation outcomes is governed as part of Probation, Confirmation and Early Employment. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For confirmation, outcomes, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

4.4 Links to lifecycle and performance procedures

Links to lifecycle and performance procedures is governed as part of Probation, Confirmation and Early Employment. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For links, lifecycle, performance, procedures, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

4 Probation, Confirmation and Early Employment - continued

5 Working Arrangements, Hours and Attendance

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 5 Working Arrangements, Hours and Attendance | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Working Arrangements, Hours and Attendance establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

5.1 Standard working-arrangement concepts

Standard working-arrangement concepts is governed as part of Working Arrangements, Hours and Attendance. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For standard, working, arrangement, concepts, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

HR-HBK-01-T04 - Working Arrangement Summary Matrix

Control point	Required treatment	Evidence
Business purpose	Must be defined before action or approval	Request/workflow record
Independent approval	No self-approval where requester benefits or is conflicted	Approval history
Specialist trigger	Route Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance/HR review when criteria apply	Concurrence record
Exception	Document scope, justification, controls and expiry	Approved exception record

5.2 Hybrid, office and client-site work

Hybrid, office and client-site work is governed as part of Working Arrangements, Hours and Attendance. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For hybrid, office, client, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

5.3 Attendance and time-recording overview

Attendance and time-recording overview is governed as part of Working Arrangements, Hours and Attendance. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For attendance, recording, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Related controlled source: Leave and Attendance Policy & Procedures Manual (HR-LV-07) §4 - Attendance and time-recording detail. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.

Operational scenario S03: Employee wants to work from a client site for a week and assumes manager approval alone is enough. Apply the requirements in Employee Handbook to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

5.4 Flexible scheduling overview

Flexible scheduling overview is governed as part of Working Arrangements, Hours and Attendance. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For flexible, scheduling, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

5.5 Escalation for attendance issues

Escalation for attendance issues is governed as part of Working Arrangements, Hours and Attendance. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For escalation, attendance, issues, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

5 Working Arrangements, Hours and Attendance - continued

6 Compensation and Benefits Overview

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 6 Compensation and Benefits Overview | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Compensation and Benefits Overview establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

6.1 Compensation components at a high level

Compensation components at a high level is governed as part of Compensation and Benefits Overview. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For compensation, components, level, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

6.2 Payroll and employee records

Payroll and employee records is governed as part of Compensation and Benefits Overview. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For payroll, employee, records, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

6.3 Benefits eligibility overview

Benefits eligibility overview is governed as part of Compensation and Benefits Overview. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For benefits, eligibility, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

6.4 Where detailed plan terms are controlled

Where detailed plan terms are controlled is governed as part of Compensation and Benefits Overview. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For where, detailed, terms, controlled, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Operational scenario S04: Employee asks whether a teammate may use their login during an urgent delivery outage. Do not share credentials. Use AccessHub/KeyFort emergency or delegated-access procedures and report suspected compromise. Operational urgency changes the escalation path, not the requirement for individual accountability.

6 Compensation and Benefits Overview - continued

7 Leave and Time Away from Work

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 7 Leave and Time Away from Work | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Leave and Time Away from Work establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

7.1 Leave framework overview

Leave framework overview is governed as part of Leave and Time Away from Work. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For leave, framework, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

HR-HBK-01-T05 - Leave Category Overview and Controlling Source

Control point	Required treatment	Evidence
Business purpose	Must be defined before action or approval	Request/workflow record
Independent approval	No self-approval where requester benefits or is conflicted	Approval history
Specialist trigger	Route Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance/HR review when criteria apply	Concurrence record
Exception	Document scope, justification, controls and expiry	Approved exception record

7.2 Common leave categories

Common leave categories is governed as part of Leave and Time Away from Work. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For common, leave, categories, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

7.3 Approval and recording overview

Approval and recording overview is governed as part of Leave and Time Away from Work. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For approval, recording, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

7.4 Unexpected absence

Unexpected absence is governed as part of Leave and Time Away from Work. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For unexpected, absence, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

7.5 Special leave and unpaid leave

Special leave and unpaid leave is governed as part of Leave and Time Away from Work. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For special, leave, unpaid, leave, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

7.6 Authoritative leave source

Authoritative leave source is governed as part of Leave and Time Away from Work. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For authoritative, leave, source, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Related controlled source: Leave and Attendance Policy & Procedures Manual (HR-LV-07) §7 - Leave categories and entitlements. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.

Operational scenario S05: Employee receives an expensive vendor gift shortly before a sourcing decision. Disclose the item, pause participation in any affected decision if independence could reasonably be questioned, and obtain Ethics/Legal guidance. During active sourcing, gifts that could influence or appear to influence the decision are not accepted.

7 Leave and Time Away from Work - continued

8 Workplace Standards and Business Conduct

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 8 Workplace Standards and Business Conduct | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Workplace Standards and Business Conduct establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

8.1 Integrity and professional behaviour

Integrity and professional behaviour is governed as part of Workplace Standards and Business Conduct. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For integrity, professional, behaviour, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

HR-HBK-01-T06 - Conduct Concern Routing Matrix

Control point	Required treatment	Evidence
Business purpose	Must be defined before action or approval	Request/workflow record
Independent approval	No self-approval where requester benefits or is conflicted	Approval history
Specialist trigger	Route Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance/HR review when criteria apply	Concurrence record
Exception	Document scope, justification, controls and expiry	Approved exception record

8.2 Respectful workplace

Respectful workplace is governed as part of Workplace Standards and Business Conduct. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For respectful, workplace, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

8.3 Conflicts, gifts and outside interests

Conflicts, gifts and outside interests is governed as part of Workplace Standards and Business Conduct. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For conflicts, gifts, outside, interests, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Related controlled source: Code of Conduct & Business Ethics (ETH-COC-01) §3 - Conflict-of-interest detail. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.

8.4 Speak-up and non-retaliation overview

Speak-up and non-retaliation overview is governed as part of Workplace Standards and Business Conduct. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For speak, retaliation, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

8.5 Investigation and discipline boundary

Investigation and discipline boundary is governed as part of Workplace Standards and Business Conduct. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For investigation, discipline, boundary, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

8.6 Business Travel, Expenses and Corporate Cards

Business Travel, Expenses and Corporate Cards is governed as part of Workplace Standards and Business Conduct. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For business, travel, expenses, corporate, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Related controlled source: Travel, Expense & Corporate Card Policy (FIN-EXP-12) §5 - Air travel and class-of-service detail. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.
Related controlled source: Travel, Expense & Corporate Card Policy (FIN-EXP-12) §11 - Corporate-card detail. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.
Related controlled source: Travel, Expense & Corporate Card Policy (FIN-EXP-12) §12 - Reimbursable/non-reimbursable expense detail. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.
Related controlled source: Travel, Expense & Corporate Card Policy (FIN-EXP-12) §14 - Expense-claim submission and deadlines. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.
Related controlled source: Travel, Expense & Corporate Card Policy (FIN-EXP-12) §15 - Travel and expense approval hierarchy. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.
Operational scenario S06: Employee accidentally sends client information to a broad internal mailing list. Apply the requirements in Employee Handbook to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

8 Workplace Standards and Business Conduct - continued

9 Information, Privacy, Security and Technology Responsibilities

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 9 Information, Privacy, Security and Technology Responsibilities | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Information, Privacy, Security and Technology Responsibilities establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

9.1 Information classification overview

Information classification overview is governed as part of Information, Privacy, Security and Technology Responsibilities. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For information, classification, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

HR-HBK-01-T07 - Information/Technology Responsibility Quick Guide

Control point	Required treatment	Evidence
Business purpose	Must be defined before action or approval	Request/workflow record
Independent approval	No self-approval where requester benefits or is conflicted	Approval history
Specialist trigger	Route Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance/HR review when criteria apply	Concurrence record
Exception	Document scope, justification, controls and expiry	Approved exception record

9.2 Confidentiality and client data

Confidentiality and client data is governed as part of Information, Privacy, Security and Technology Responsibilities. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For confidentiality, client, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

9.3 Passwords, access and acceptable technology use

Passwords, access and acceptable technology use is governed as part of Information, Privacy, Security and Technology Responsibilities. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For passwords, access, acceptable, technology, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Related controlled source: Identity, Access Management & Acceptable Technology Use Standard (IAM-STD-03) §5 - Credential/password/MFA requirements. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.

9.4 Privacy responsibilities

Privacy responsibilities is governed as part of Information, Privacy, Security and Technology Responsibilities. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For privacy, responsibilities, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

9.5 AI and GenAI use overview

AI and GenAI use overview is governed as part of Information, Privacy, Security and Technology Responsibilities. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For genai, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

9.6 Security and privacy incident reporting

Security and privacy incident reporting is governed as part of Information, Privacy, Security and Technology Responsibilities. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For security, privacy, incident, reporting, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Operational scenario S07: Employee wants to paste customer data into a public LLM to summarize it. Stop further submission, preserve the relevant details, notify the Security Operations Centre and Privacy where personal/client data may be involved, and follow AI-GOV-05 for use-case/tool review. Do not attempt to erase evidence by altering logs or accounts.

9 Information, Privacy, Security and Technology Responsibilities - continued

10 Learning and Capability Development

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 10 Learning and Capability Development | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Learning and Capability Development establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

10.1 Mandatory learning

Mandatory learning is governed as part of Learning and Capability Development. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For mandatory, learning, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

10.2 Role-based learning

Role-based learning is governed as part of Learning and Capability Development. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For based, learning, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

10.3 LearnSphere records

LearnSphere records is governed as part of Learning and Capability Development. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For learnsphere, records, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

10.4 Development planning overview

Development planning overview is governed as part of Learning and Capability Development. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For development, planning, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

11 Performance Management Overview

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 11 Performance Management Overview | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Performance Management Overview establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

11.1 Performance cycle

Performance cycle is governed as part of Performance Management Overview. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For performance, cycle, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

11.2 Goals and check-ins

Goals and check-ins is governed as part of Performance Management Overview. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For goals, check, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Operational scenario S08: Band 4 employee asks about business-class eligibility on an eight-hour international flight. Band 4-5 international travel of at least eight hours is premium economy under FIN-EXP-12, not business class. Business class requires the eligible band rule or a documented approved exception.

11.3 Ratings and calibration overview

Ratings and calibration overview is governed as part of Performance Management Overview. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For ratings, calibration, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

11.4 Underperformance and improvement planning

Underperformance and improvement planning is governed as part of Performance Management Overview. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For underperformance, improvement, planning, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

11.5 Authoritative performance source

Authoritative performance source is governed as part of Performance Management Overview. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For authoritative, performance, source, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Related controlled source: Performance Management & Career Development Policy (HR-PM-08) §2 - Performance cycle and governance. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.

11 Performance Management Overview - continued

12 Career Growth and Internal Mobility

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 12 Career Growth and Internal Mobility | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Career Growth and Internal Mobility establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

12.1 Career bands and growth

Career bands and growth is governed as part of Career Growth and Internal Mobility. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For career, bands, growth, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

HR-HBK-01-T08 - Career and Mobility Route Map

Control point	Required treatment	Evidence
Business purpose	Must be defined before action or approval	Request/workflow record
Independent approval	No self-approval where requester benefits or is conflicted	Approval history
Specialist trigger	Route Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance/HR review when criteria apply	Concurrence record
Exception	Document scope, justification, controls and expiry	Approved exception record

12.2 Promotion overview

Promotion overview is governed as part of Career Growth and Internal Mobility. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For promotion, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

12.3 Internal opportunities

Internal opportunities is governed as part of Career Growth and Internal Mobility. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For internal, opportunities, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Operational scenario S09: Employee disputes a performance rating and treats the issue as an ethics investigation. Apply the requirements in Employee Handbook to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

12.4 Transfer and role-change overview

Transfer and role-change overview is governed as part of Career Growth and Internal Mobility. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For transfer, change, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Related controlled source: Onboarding, Internal Transfer & Offboarding SOP (HR-SOP-06) §9 - Transfer/role-change execution. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.

12.5 Mobility approval boundaries

Mobility approval boundaries is governed as part of Career Growth and Internal Mobility. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For mobility, approval, boundaries, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

12 Career Growth and Internal Mobility - continued

13 Employee Concerns, Grievances and Speak-Up

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 13 Employee Concerns, Grievances and Speak-Up | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Employee Concerns, Grievances and Speak-Up establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

13.1 Informal resolution

Informal resolution is governed as part of Employee Concerns, Grievances and Speak-Up. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For informal, resolution, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

13.2 People & Culture channels

People & Culture channels is governed as part of Employee Concerns, Grievances and Speak-Up. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For people, culture, channels, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

13.3 Ethics concerns

Ethics concerns is governed as part of Employee Concerns, Grievances and Speak-Up. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For ethics, concerns, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

13.4 Security/privacy-specific escalation

Security/privacy-specific escalation is governed as part of Employee Concerns, Grievances and Speak-Up. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For security, privacy, specific, escalation, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Operational scenario S10: Employee resigns while holding a corporate laptop, privileged access, and active client tasks. Apply the requirements in Employee Handbook to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

13.5 Non-retaliation boundary

Non-retaliation boundary is governed as part of Employee Concerns, Grievances and Speak-Up. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For retaliation, boundary, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

14 Discipline and Corrective Action

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 14 Discipline and Corrective Action | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Discipline and Corrective Action establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

14.1 Purpose and principles

Purpose and principles is governed as part of Discipline and Corrective Action. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For purpose, principles, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

14.2 Separation from performance management

Separation from performance management is governed as part of Discipline and Corrective Action. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For separation, performance, management, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

14.3 Investigation handoff

Investigation handoff is governed as part of Discipline and Corrective Action. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For investigation, handoff, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

14.4 Possible outcomes at a high level

Possible outcomes at a high level is governed as part of Discipline and Corrective Action. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For possible, outcomes, level, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

14.5 Records and confidentiality

Records and confidentiality is governed as part of Discipline and Corrective Action. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For records, confidentiality, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

15 Resignation, Termination and Other Separations

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 15 Resignation, Termination and Other Separations | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Resignation, Termination and Other Separations establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

15.1 Resignation overview

Resignation overview is governed as part of Resignation, Termination and Other Separations. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For resignation, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

HR-HBK-01-T09 - Separation Responsibilities Overview

Control point	Required treatment	Evidence
Business purpose	Must be defined before action or approval	Request/workflow record
Independent approval	No self-approval where requester benefits or is conflicted	Approval history
Specialist trigger	Route Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance/HR review when criteria apply	Concurrence record
Exception	Document scope, justification, controls and expiry	Approved exception record
Operational scenario S11: Employee reports harassment but asks their manager to keep it completely off record. Apply the requirements in Employee Handbook to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.		

15.2 Notice-period overview

Notice-period overview is governed as part of Resignation, Termination and Other Separations. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For notice, period, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

15.3 Knowledge transfer

Knowledge transfer is governed as part of Resignation, Termination and Other Separations. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For knowledge, transfer, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

15.4 Asset return and access removal

Asset return and access removal is governed as part of Resignation, Termination and Other Separations. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For asset, return, access, removal, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Related controlled source: Onboarding, Internal Transfer & Offboarding SOP (HR-SOP-06) §15 - Access revocation in separation. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.

15.5 Final settlement overview

Final settlement overview is governed as part of Resignation, Termination and Other Separations. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For final, settlement, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

15.6 Rehire eligibility overview

Rehire eligibility overview is governed as part of Resignation, Termination and Other Separations. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For rehire, eligibility, overview, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

16 Retirement, Employment Verification and References

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 16 Retirement, Employment Verification and References | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Retirement, Employment Verification and References establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

16.1 Retirement administration

Retirement administration is governed as part of Retirement, Employment Verification and References. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For retirement, administration, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

16.2 Employment verification

Employment verification is governed as part of Retirement, Employment Verification and References. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For employment, verification, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

16.3 References and external confirmations

References and external confirmations is governed as part of Retirement, Employment Verification and References. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For references, external, confirmations, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Operational scenario S12: Manager wants to move an employee to a new project before the formal internal-transfer workflow is complete. Apply the requirements in Employee Handbook to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

16.4 Records ownership

Records ownership is governed as part of Retirement, Employment Verification and References. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For records, ownership, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

17 Interpretation, Exceptions and Escalation

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section 17 Interpretation, Exceptions and Escalation | People & Culture | INTERNAL

Interpretation, Exceptions and Escalation establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Employee Handbook. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

17.1 Policy precedence

Policy precedence is governed as part of Interpretation, Exceptions and Escalation. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For policy, precedence, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

17.2 Who may interpret handbook summaries

Who may interpret handbook summaries is governed as part of Interpretation, Exceptions and Escalation. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For interpret, handbook, summaries, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

17.3 Exceptions owned by specialist policies

Exceptions owned by specialist policies is governed as part of Interpretation, Exceptions and Escalation. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For exceptions, owned, specialist, policies, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

17.4 Escalation to People Governance Council

Escalation to People Governance Council is governed as part of Interpretation, Exceptions and Escalation. The handbook explains the employee-facing rule and the route to the controlled specialist source.

For escalation, people, governance, council, the recorded employment category, current role, manager relationship and approved effective dates must be checked before a decision is finalized. Employees are expected to ask when a condition is unclear rather than assume a general summary overrides a specialist requirement.

- Employees keep PeopleHub information reasonably current and follow the specialist source when the handbook points to one.
- Managers explain expectations, apply rules consistently and escalate exceptions rather than creating local policy.
- Exceptions must be documented in the controlled workflow and may not be created by custom team practice.
- Where a verified external or client requirement is stricter, People & Culture or the specialist owner determines the applicable treatment.

Appendices, Forms and Checklists

Employee Handbook | HR-HBK-01 | v6.2 | Effective 2026-07-01 | Section Appendices Controlled execution aids | People & Culture | INTERNAL

HR-HBK-01-AA Employee Handbook Definitions

Term	Controlled meaning
Worker	Umbrella term covering employees and non-employee workers with an Aurelius work relationship or approved access.
Employee	Worker in RFT, RPT, or FXT category. Interns, apprentices, contractors, consultants, temporary staff, and vendor personnel are not called Employees unless a specific engagement record explicitly says otherwise.
Non-Employee Worker	Worker in INT, APP, CTR, CNS, TMP, or VND category for registry purposes.
People Manager	Manager with formal direct reports in PeopleHub. A project lead is not automatically a People Manager.
Line Manager	The PeopleHub-recorded manager responsible for routine people approvals and supervision.
Exception	Prospective, documented, time-bounded authorization to deviate from a stated internal requirement under an approved process.
Record	Information retained as evidence of a business decision, transaction, approval, obligation, incident, or controlled activity.
Source of Truth	Designated authoritative system or controlled document for a particular fact or process. Convenience copies do not override it.

Appendices - continued

HR-HBK-01-AB People Support and Specialist Contact Matrix

Contact	Purpose
peoplehelp@aureliusdigital.example	General HR and People Operations support
leave@aureliusdigital.example	Leave/attendance administration escalations not resolved in PeopleHub

Appendices - continued

Appendices - continued

HR-HBK-01-AC New Employee 30-Day Orientation Checklist

Use this checklist as an execution aid. It does not create an exception or replace an approval required by the controlling section.

- Confirm the request or event is within the scope of Employee Handbook.
- Verify the authoritative worker, system, vendor, expense, incident or model record before taking action.
- Identify conditions that change the rule, including employment category, band, data classification, risk level, location, client assignment or service criticality.
- Obtain independent approval and specialist concurrence where the policy requires it.
- Record the decision, evidence, exception conditions and any expiry or follow-up date in the designated system.
- Escalate unresolved conflicts to the Policy Owner rather than creating a local workaround.

Appendices - continued

HR-HBK-01-AD Where Do I Find the Detailed Rule? Index

Use this checklist as an execution aid. It does not create an exception or replace an approval required by the controlling section.

- Confirm the request or event is within the scope of Employee Handbook.
- Verify the authoritative worker, system, vendor, expense, incident or model record before taking action.
- Identify conditions that change the rule, including employment category, band, data classification, risk level, location, client assignment or service criticality.
- Obtain independent approval and specialist concurrence where the policy requires it.
- Record the decision, evidence, exception conditions and any expiry or follow-up date in the designated system.
- Escalate unresolved conflicts to the Policy Owner rather than creating a local workaround.

Appendices - continued

Appendices - continued

HR-HBK-01-AE Employee Lifecycle at a Glance

Use this checklist as an execution aid. It does not create an exception or replace an approval required by the controlling section.

- Confirm the request or event is within the scope of Employee Handbook.
- Verify the authoritative worker, system, vendor, expense, incident or model record before taking action.
- Identify conditions that change the rule, including employment category, band, data classification, risk level, location, client assignment or service criticality.
- Obtain independent approval and specialist concurrence where the policy requires it.
- Record the decision, evidence, exception conditions and any expiry or follow-up date in the designated system.
- Escalate unresolved conflicts to the Policy Owner rather than creating a local workaround.

Appendices - continued

HR-HBK-01-F01 Employee Handbook Acknowledgement Record

Field	Entry / controlled record
Requester / worker name	
Employee or worker ID	
Department / project	
Manager / sponsor	
Date / effective period	
Business purpose	
Requested action or decision	
Supporting evidence	
Approvals / concurrence	
Exception or risk notes	
Closure / outcome	
Record location	

Appendices - continued